

Polynomial End Behavior, Zeros & Multiplicity

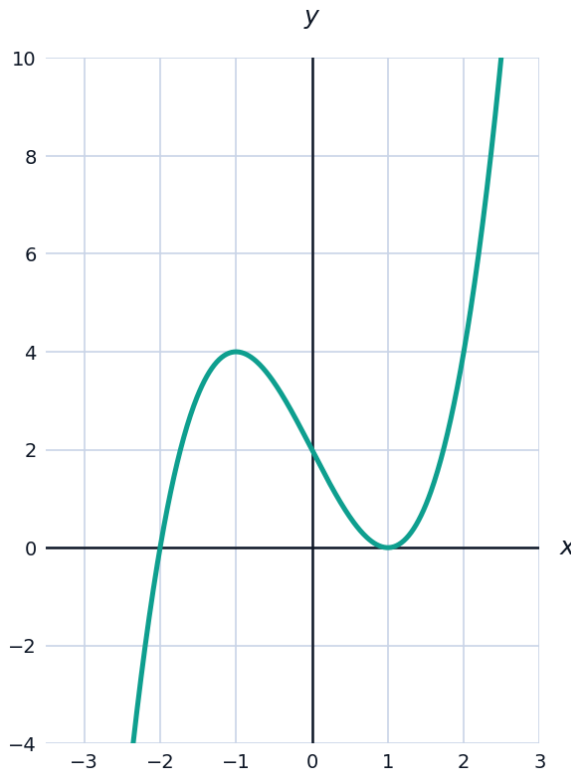


End behavior of polynomial functions

- 1 State the end behavior of $f(x) = -2x^5 + 3x^2 - 1$, using the leading term.
 - 2 State the end behavior of $f(x) = 3x^4 - 5x^3 + 2$.
-

Zeros and their multiplicities

- 3 Find the zeros of $f(x) = (x - 2)^3(x + 1)^2$ and state the multiplicity and graphical behavior at each.
- 4 The graph shows $f(x) = (x + 2)(x - 1)^2$, illustrating a crossing zero at $x = -2$ and a touching zero at $x = 1$.



The Rational Zero Theorem

- 5 List all possible rational zeros of $f(x) = 2x^3 - 3x^2 - 8x + 12$ using the Rational Zero Theorem, then find the actual zeros.
-

Constructing a polynomial from its zeros

- 6 Write a polynomial function of least degree with real coefficients, zeros at $x = -1$ (multiplicity 2) and $x = 3$ (multiplicity 1), and a leading coefficient of 1.
- 7 A polynomial has zeros at $x = 0$, $x = 2$, and $x = -3$, all with multiplicity 1, and passes through $(1, 8)$. Find the polynomial in the form $f(x) = a \cdot x(x - 2)(x + 3)$.
-

Local extrema and turning points

- 8 A polynomial of degree n has at most how many turning points (local extrema)? State the rule and apply it to a degree-5 polynomial.
- 9 The graph of a polynomial shows exactly 3 turning points. What is the minimum possible degree of the polynomial?
-

Average rate of change and concavity

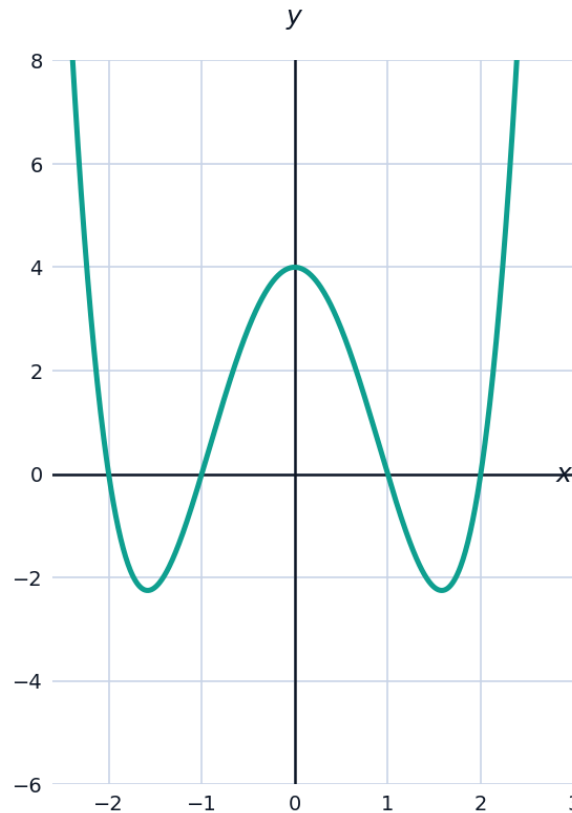
- 10 Find the average rate of change (AROC) of $f(x) = x^3 - 4x$ on $[1, 3]$.
- 11 For $f(x) = x^3 - 4x$, compare the AROC on $[0, 1]$ and $[1, 2]$, and use the comparison to determine whether f is concave up or concave down on this interval.
-

Sign charts and interval analysis

- 12 Build a sign chart for $f(x) = (x + 1)(x - 2)(x - 4)$ and state the intervals where $f(x) > 0$.
- 13 Use a sign chart to solve the inequality $(x - 1)^2(x + 3) \leq 0$.
-

Visualizing end behavior families

- 14 The graph shows $f(x) = x^4 - 5x^2 + 4$, a degree-4 polynomial with four real zeros.



- a State the end behavior of the graph as $x \rightarrow \pm \infty$.
- b Identify the four zeros shown and state whether each is a crossing or touching zero.
- c How many turning points does the graph display, and is this consistent with the degree?

Putting it together: a full analysis

- 15 For $f(x) = x^3 + 2x^2 - 5x - 6$: verify that $x = -1$ is a zero, factor completely, then describe the end behavior and the behavior at each zero.